



“Obviously the BJP is more concerned about cricket. They make politics of inflation, terrorism, and now politics of cricket.”

KAPIL SIBAL,
Congress spokesperson



“Team owners will find it very difficult to protect balance-sheets as expenditure will be higher and income much lower.”

ANIRBAN DAS BLAH,
CEO, Globosport



“We have to respect the elections in the country. That is a bigger issue than ours. I will miss the Eden Gardens too much.”

SHAH RUKH KHAN, Owner,
Kolkata Knight Riders

SIPRA DAS



HEMANT CHAWLA



Super Kings instead. Says Rakesh Singh, chief marketing officer of the Chennai Super Kings: “Main title sponsors, who will have their logos on the jersey, are protected. However, those sponsors with whom we had on-the-ground partnerships will be affected as the venue has changed.” For instance, Café Coffee Day, which had signed on as food and beverage partner for three teams at their home grounds simply won’t be now and is unlikely to cough up any money.

Even Shah Rukh Khan has retained most of his sponsors, except HDIL, thanks to his involvement, long-term deals struck by many other franchisees are coming apart. Last week, Rajasthan Royals, the Jaipur franchise, and Bajaj Allianz mutually agreed to part ways, after withdrawing the court cases in Delhi and Mumbai respectively. Also working against the IPL is the T-20 World Cup scheduled to be held a few weeks after the IPL ends, where sponsors believe the emotional connect with Team India is far deeper.

So where does that leave the franchisees? Higher television rights are likely to save the day. In the early years, IPL offered a higher share in media and sponsorship revenues to the eight franchisees. In the first five

years, IPL will divide 80 per cent of the revenues from media rights with franchise owners. This apart, 60 per cent of the central sponsorships—\$153 million for five years—will be divided between team owners. Also this year, the BCCI has promised to underwrite some of the teams’ losses, thanks to a new media rights deal.

by Mallini Bhupta

WHAT REALLY SENT THE IPL OVERSEAS?

Home Minister P. Chidambaram could not have put it better—“IPL is a shrewd combination of sport and business. There is no reason to add politics to this combination.” There was no way politics could have been kept out either. A majority of states were willing to take responsibility for providing security at their own risk. Chidambaram says that only three states and one Union territory—Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Punjab and Chandigarh—got back with their official response. What he forgot to mention was that they were the only ones to respond to the third reworked schedule. Most of the other states—barring Maharashtra and Delhi—